

3. Close this dialog box and then click the second tab—'Wireless Network'. Here, at the bottom, click 'Add', which will launch another dialog box where we need to assign a name for Network Name (SSID). Check 'WEP' and 'Key provided automatically' for the rest to seamlessly connect to this AP. Press OK once through with these settings. Now click 'Refresh' in the 'Wireless Network' dialog box, and the network name will appear in the 'available networks' area.

4. Configure the client systems that will connect to the soft AP, and eventually to other client systems through it. For this, go to the 'Network properties' dialog box and assign an IP in the same range. For example, if you assigned 192.168.1.1, assign 192.168.1.2 and so on to the other client systems. Now click on 'Subnet mask', and it appears automatically.

5. Right-click on the network icon in the system tray. This will launch a dialog box that will display the name of the soft AP. Check 'Allow me to connect to the selected network'. This will highlight the Connect button at the bottom. Just click it, and you should be able to connect to the other machines.

Repeat the exercise with the other client machines, and you will be able to connect each to the other, all without an Access Point.

3.3: Sharing An Internet Connection

If you are going to use wireless router with a DSL or cable modem inbuilt, you will not have to use any third party tool like SyGate. Here we take a look at both scenarios—a normal Access Point and a cable or DSL wireless router.

Sharing An Internet Connection Using A Wireless Router

To share an Internet connection between two or more systems using a wireless router, you will need some information handy,